

General Knowledge

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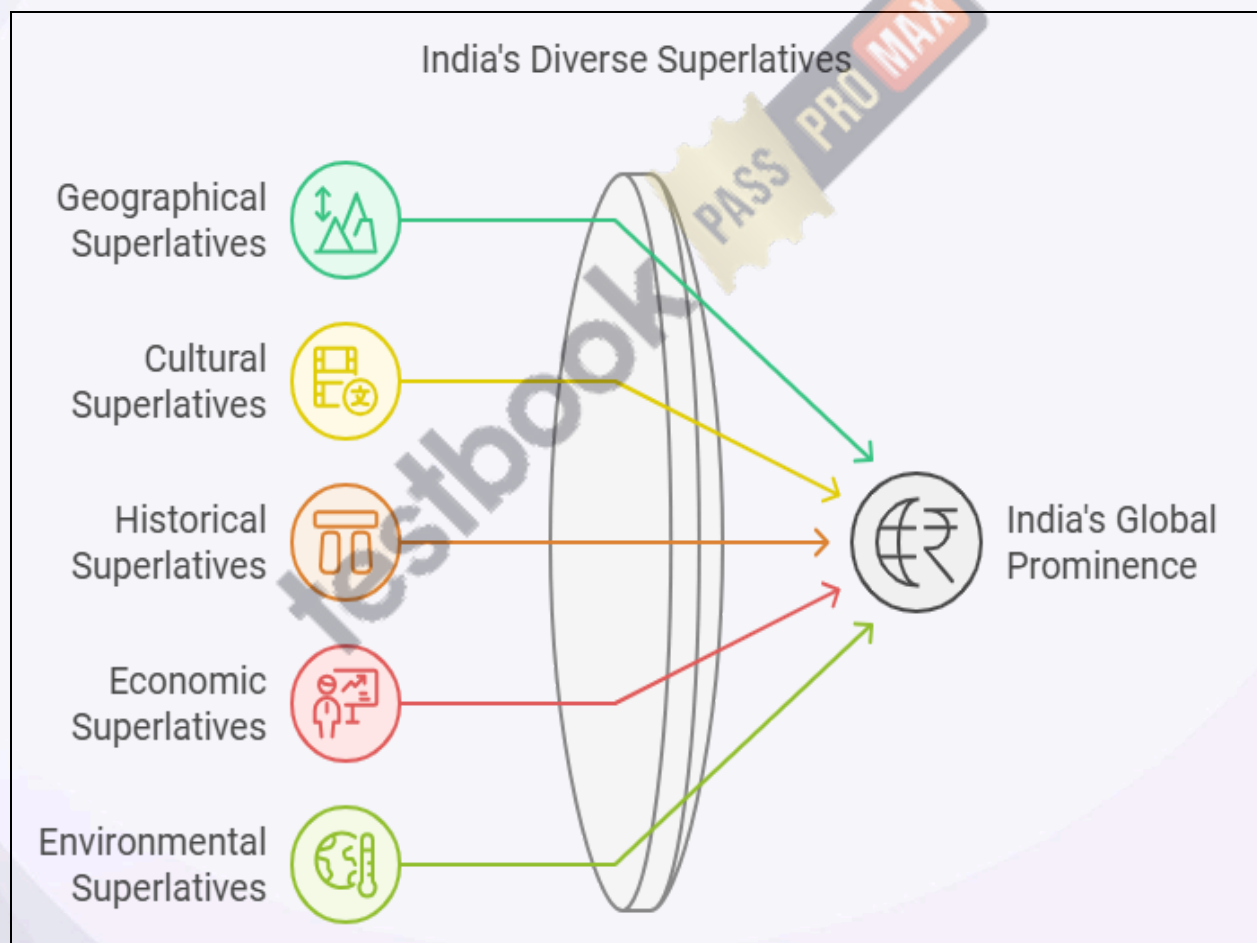
STUDY NOTES

Superlatives Of India



Superlatives Of India

India is home to remarkable **superlatives**, showcasing the extremes of geography with its **tallest, longest, biggest, smallest, and highest features**. In addition to the **natural wonders**, the country boasts human-made structures that date back to ancient times, displaying exquisite artistry and serving as major tourist attractions. Some of these edifices are from the past, while others are more modern.



Geographical Superlatives

Superlative	Description
Highest Point	Kangchenjunga (8,586 meters / 28,169 feet) - Located in the Eastern Himalayas, Kangchenjunga is the third-highest mountain in the world, marking the highest point in India.
Lowest Point	Kuttanad (0 meters / 0 feet) - Situated in Kerala, this is the lowest point in India, lying below sea level in the backwaters of the state.
Largest State by Area	Rajasthan (342,239 km ²) - Located in the north-western part of India, Rajasthan is the largest state in terms of area.
Smallest State by Area	Goa (3,702 km ²) - A coastal state located on the western side of India, Goa is the smallest state in terms of area.
Largest City by Area	Bengaluru (709 km ²) - Bengaluru, the capital of Karnataka, is the largest city in India by area.
Largest City by Population	Mumbai (approx. 20 million) - Mumbai, the financial capital of India, is the most populous city in India.
Longest River	Ganga (2,525 km) - Originating from the Himalayas, the Ganga is the longest river in India, flowing through northern and eastern parts of the country.
Largest Freshwater Lake	Vembanad (230 km ²) - Located in Kerala, Vembanad is the largest freshwater lake in India.
Largest Desert	Thar Desert (200,000 km ²) - Spanning Rajasthan, Gujarat, Punjab, and Haryana, the Thar Desert is the largest desert in India.

Highest Lake	Lake Tsomgo (3,753 meters / 12,313 feet) - Located in Sikkim, Lake Tsomgo is one of the highest lakes in India, surrounded by the Himalayas.
Largest Island	Andaman Island (6,408 km ²) - Located in the Bay of Bengal, Andaman is the largest island in India.
Largest National Park	Hemis National Park (4,400 km ²) - Situated in Jammu and Kashmir, it is the largest national park in India, home to the endangered snow leopard.
Tallest Statue	Statue of Unity (182 meters / 597 feet) - Located in Gujarat, it is the tallest statue in the world, honouring Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel.
Northernmost Point	Indira Col (35° 40' N) - Located in the Ladakh region, this is the northernmost point in India.
Southernmost Point	Indira Point (6° 45' N) - Located in the Nicobar Islands, this is the southernmost point of India.
Westernmost Point	Ghuar Moti (68° 10' E) - Located in the Kutch district of Gujarat, it is the westernmost point of India.
Easternmost Point	Kibithu (97° 30' E) - Situated in Arunachal Pradesh, Kibithu is the easternmost point in India.

Cultural superlatives

Superlative	Description
Largest Film Industry	Bollywood - The Hindi film industry, based in Mumbai, is the largest in terms of film production and revenue.

Most Popular Festival	Diwali - Diwali, the Festival of Lights, is the most widely celebrated festival across India, symbolizing the victory of light over darkness and good over evil.
Largest Religious Gathering	Kumbh Mela - The Kumbh Mela, held every 12 years in rotating locations (Allahabad, Haridwar, Nashik, and Ujjain), is the largest religious gathering in the world.
Oldest Continuous Civilization	Indus Valley Civilization - One of the oldest civilizations in the world, it flourished around 3300-1300 BCE, with advanced urban planning and trade systems.
Largest Religious Minority	Islam - With approximately 14% of the population, Islam is the largest religious minority in India, with a rich history and cultural influence in the country.
Largest Language Family	Indo-Aryan Languages - The Indo-Aryan language family is the largest in India, encompassing languages like Hindi, Bengali, Punjabi, Marathi, and more.
Most Widely Spoken Language	Hindi - Hindi is the most widely spoken language in India, spoken by around 44% of the population as a mother tongue.
Largest Democracy	India - With over 1.4 billion people, India is the largest democracy in the world, holding regular elections at national, state, and local levels.
Oldest Known Script	Brahmi Script - The Brahmi script, dating back to around 3rd century BCE, is considered one of the earliest writing systems used in India and across the Indian subcontinent.

Most Famous Classical Dance Form	Bharatanatyam - Originating from Tamil Nadu, Bharatanatyam is one of the oldest and most famous classical dance forms of India, known for its grace and storytelling.
Largest Temple Complex	Akshardham Temple (Delhi) - The Akshardham Temple in Delhi is the largest temple complex in India, known for its intricate carvings, exhibitions, and grand architecture.
Most Popular Sport	Cricket - Cricket is the most popular and widely followed sport in India, with millions of fans and a deeply ingrained part of the country's culture.
Largest Mela (Fair)	Pushkar Fair (Rajasthan) - The Pushkar Fair is one of the largest and most famous religious and cultural fairs in India, held annually in Rajasthan, attracting millions of visitors.
Oldest Living Tradition of Yoga	Yoga - Yoga, originating in ancient India, is a practice for physical, mental, and spiritual well-being, with a long tradition that continues to thrive globally.
Largest Annual Cultural Event	Rath Yatra (Puri, Odisha) - The Rath Yatra is an annual event where Lord Jagannath, along with his siblings, is carried in a procession, drawing millions of devotees.
Largest Traditional Textile Collection	Kanchipuram Silk Sarees - Kanchipuram, a town in Tamil Nadu, is known for producing the finest silk sarees, which are deeply connected to Indian tradition and craftsmanship.

Historical superlatives

Superlative	Description
Largest Ancient Empire	Maurya Empire - At its height, the Maurya Empire (c. 322-185 BCE) covered most of the Indian subcontinent, making it the largest empire in ancient India.
Oldest Monumental Structure	The Great Bath of Mohenjo-Daro - Dating back to around 2600 BCE, the Great Bath is one of the oldest monumental structures found in the Indus Valley Civilization.
Most Powerful Dynasty	Gupta Dynasty - The Gupta Empire (c. 320-550 CE) is considered one of the most powerful in ancient India, known for its achievements in art, science, and literature.
Longest Reigning Dynasty	Chola Dynasty - The Chola dynasty (c. 300 BCE - 1279 CE) had one of the longest reigns in Indian history, leaving a lasting legacy in South India and Southeast Asia.
First Emperor of Unified India	Chandragupta Maurya - Chandragupta Maurya founded the Maurya Empire in 322 BCE, uniting much of India under one rule for the first time in recorded history.
Longest Reigning Monarch	Raja Raja Chola I - Raja Raja Chola I (c. 985-1014 CE) was one of the longest-reigning rulers of the Chola dynasty, greatly expanding its influence and building grand temples.
Largest Indian Kingdom	Gupta Empire - At its peak, the Gupta Empire was one of the largest and most prosperous kingdoms, covering much of northern and central India.

Most Successful Conqueror	Samudragupta - Known as the "Napoleon of India," Samudragupta of the Gupta Dynasty (c. 335–380 CE) led successful military campaigns, expanding the empire significantly.
Most Significant Mughal Emperor	Akbar the Great - Akbar (reigned 1556–1605) is considered one of the most influential rulers of the Mughal Empire, known for his military conquests, cultural contributions, and religious tolerance.
First Woman Ruler of India	Rani Durgavati - Rani Durgavati was the queen of Gondwana (1564–1569) and is one of the earliest recorded female rulers of India, known for her valour against the Mughal invaders.
Largest Revolt Against British Rule	The Indian Rebellion of 1857 - Also known as the First War of Indian Independence, the 1857 uprising was the largest and most significant revolt against British rule.
Longest Serving Prime Minister	Jawaharlal Nehru - Jawaharlal Nehru served as the first Prime Minister of independent India for 17 years (1947–1964), making him the longest-serving prime minister.
First War of Indian Independence	The Indian Rebellion of 1857 - Known as the Sepoy Mutiny or First War of Indian Independence, it was the first major uprising against British colonial rule in India.
Most Successful Indian Independence Movement Leader	Mahatma Gandhi - Gandhi led India's non-violent struggle for independence from British colonial rule through methods like satyagraha and non-cooperation.

Oldest Known Civilization in India	Indus Valley Civilization - One of the world's oldest urban civilisations, the Indus Valley Civilization (c. 3300-1300 BCE) is known for its advanced cities, technology, and trade.
First Indian to Receive the Nobel Prize	Rabindranath Tagore - Tagore was the first Indian to win the Nobel Prize, receiving the Nobel in Literature in 1913 for his collection of poems, "Gitanjali."

Economic superlatives

Superlative	Description
Largest Economy by Purchasing Power Parity	India is the world's third-largest economy by purchasing power parity (PPP), which accounts for differences in living costs and inflation rates across countries.
Fastest Growing Major Economy	India has been one of the fastest-growing major economies in the world in recent decades, with an average GDP growth rate of around 6-7% annually.
Largest Agricultural Producer	India is the world's largest producer of several agricultural products, including milk, rice, and spices, making agriculture a significant part of its economy.
Most Significant Exporter of Services	India is the world's largest exporter of IT and business process outsourcing services, contributing significantly to its GDP.
Largest Labor Force	India has the largest labour force in the world, with more than 500 million people employed or seeking employment.

Largest Consumer Market	With a population exceeding 1.4 billion, India is one of the largest consumer markets in the world, attracting global companies and driving domestic consumption.
Largest Remittance Receiver	India receives the highest amount of remittances in the world, with millions of Indians working abroad and sending money back home to their families.
Largest Renewable Energy Market	India is the largest renewable energy market in the world, with an ambitious goal to generate 500 GW of renewable energy by 2030.
Largest Producer of Textiles	India is the largest producer and exporter of textiles and garments globally, accounting for a significant portion of the world's textile trade.
Largest Consumer of Gold	India is the largest consumer of gold, with a cultural affinity for gold in jewellery, especially during festivals like Diwali and weddings.
Largest Motorcycle Market	India - India is the largest market for motorcycles, with millions of motorcycles sold every year, especially in rural areas where motorcycles are popular for commuting.
World's Largest Car Manufacturer	Maruti Suzuki - Maruti Suzuki is India's largest car manufacturer and one of the largest in the world, producing millions of vehicles annually for both domestic and global markets.
Largest Producer of Jute	India is the world's largest producer of jute, a natural fibre used for making products like bags, carpets, and ropes.

Highest FDI Inflows in South Asia	India is the largest recipient of Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) in South Asia, with a rapidly growing economy and favourable investment policies.
Largest Insurance Market in South Asia	India has the largest insurance market in South Asia, with a growing number of life and non-life insurance policies being purchased every year.

Environmental Superlatives

Superlative	Description
Largest Mangrove Forest Area	Sundarbans Mangrove Forest - Located in West Bengal, the Sundarbans is the largest mangrove forest in the world, home to a rich biodiversity, including the Bengal tiger.
Largest River Island	Majuli - Majuli, located in the Brahmaputra River in Assam, is the largest river island in the world, known for its unique culture, ecology, and vibrant festivals.
Largest Desert	Thar Desert - Spanning Rajasthan and parts of Punjab, Haryana, and Gujarat, the Thar is India's largest desert and the world's 17th-largest hot desert.
Most Biodiverse Region	Western Ghats - The Western Ghats are one of the world's eight "hottest hotspots" of biological diversity, with thousands of species of flora and fauna, many of which are endemic.
Largest Tiger Reserve	Jim Corbett National Park - Located in Uttarakhand, it is not only the oldest national park in India but also one of the largest tiger reserves, part of the Project Tiger initiative.

Largest Wetland	Sundarbans Wetlands - The Sundarbans, as a wetland region, is the largest in India, stretching across parts of West Bengal and Bangladesh and providing crucial ecological services.
Largest National Park	Hemis National Park - Located in Jammu and Kashmir, this park is the largest in India, covering an area of 4,400 square kilometers, and is known for its rich wildlife.
Most Endangered Species	The Bengal Tiger - The Bengal tiger, found primarily in the Sundarbans and other regions, is one of the most endangered species in India, though conservation efforts are ongoing.
Largest Freshwater Lake	Vembanad Lake - Located in Kerala, Vembanad is the largest freshwater lake in India, known for its unique ecosystem and bird sanctuary.
Largest Green Cover in a Metropolitan Area	Bengaluru - Bengaluru is known for its expansive green cover and numerous parks, making it one of the greenest cities in India.
Highest Biodiversity Hotspot	Eastern Himalayas - The Eastern Himalayas, stretching across Arunachal Pradesh, Sikkim, and parts of Bhutan and Nepal, are considered the highest biodiversity hotspot in India.
Largest Forest Cover	Madhya Pradesh - Madhya Pradesh has the largest area of forest cover among Indian states, encompassing a variety of ecosystems, including tropical and temperate forests.
Highest Peak in India	Kangchenjunga - At 8,586 meters (28,169 feet), Kangchenjunga is the highest peak in India and the third-highest mountain in the world, located on the border with Nepal.

Largest Seacoast	India - India has the longest coastline among all countries in South Asia, stretching over 7,500 kilometres along its eastern and western coasts.
Most Extensive Coral Reef	Gulf of Mannar - The Gulf of Mannar, located between India and Sri Lanka, is home to the most extensive coral reefs in India, providing rich marine biodiversity.

Other important superlatives related to India

Superlative	Description
Largest Democracy	India is the world's largest democracy, with over 1.4 billion people and a multi-party system, holding regular elections at local, state, and national levels.
Most Populous Country	India is the second most populous country in the world (after China) with over 1.4 billion people and is expected to surpass China in population by 2027.
Largest Network of Railways	Indian Railways - Indian Railways operates the largest rail network in the world, spanning over 67,000 kilometers, and connecting remote parts of the country.
Most Diverse Cuisine	Indian Cuisine - Indian cuisine is known for its vast diversity in flavours, spices, and regional variations, making it one of the most varied cuisines in the world.
Longest Running TV Show	"Kaun Banega Crorepati" (KBC) - Based on the "Who Wants to Be a Millionaire" format, this quiz show has been running for over two decades and is one of India's most popular TV shows.

Highest Number of Languages Spoken	India is home to 22 officially recognised languages and hundreds of dialects, making it the most linguistically diverse country in the world.
Largest Book Fair	World Book Fair (New Delhi) - The New Delhi World Book Fair is the largest book fair in India and one of the largest in the world, attracting thousands of publishers and readers.
Most Widely Read Author	Chetan Bhagat - Chetan Bhagat is considered one of India's most widely read and bestselling authors, known for books that resonate with India's youth.
Largest Producer of Milk	India is the world's largest producer of milk, with a thriving dairy industry, particularly in states like Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, and Gujarat.
Highest-Grossing Film Industry	Bollywood - Bollywood, the Hindi-language film industry based in Mumbai, is one of the highest-grossing film industries globally, with billions in box office revenue.
Largest Producer of Tea	India - India is the world's largest producer of tea, with major tea-growing regions in Assam, Darjeeling, and Nilgiris.
Most Visited Tourist Destination	Taj Mahal - The Taj Mahal in Agra, one of the Seven Wonders of the World, is the most visited tourist destination in India and attracts millions of visitors annually.
Largest E-commerce Market	India is one of the largest and fastest-growing e-commerce markets globally, driven by a large internet user base and increasing online shopping habits.
Oldest Living Civilization	Indian Civilization - India is home to one of the world's oldest continuous civilisations, dating back more than 5,000 years, with the Indus Valley Civilization.

First Country to Reach Mars in Its First Attempt	India - In 2014, India became the first country to successfully reach Mars orbit in its first attempt, with the Mars Orbiter Mission (Mangalyaan).
Largest Vaccine Manufacturer	Serum Institute of India - The Serum Institute of India is the world's largest vaccine manufacturer by volume, producing vaccines for diseases like polio, hepatitis, and COVID-19.